

“Understanding Trust Breakdowns in Viral Digital Content”

Problem statement: Digital platforms, especially messaging platforms, are a primary source of news, alerts, and social information for users across India. Alongside this growth, users are increasingly exposed to misleading, manipulated, or synthetic content such as edited videos, false claims, and AI-generated media.

While platforms and institutions attempt to respond through reporting and fact-checking, these interventions often occur after content has already spread widely. As a result, users frequently struggle to decide what to trust in real time, especially when content appears urgent, emotional, or authoritative.

To get started, perform the following for the first round of the case submission:

- Get an understanding of the digital content space in India: the market size, competitor landscape, the regulations, the different actors involved in the ecosystem
- Do an analysis of the kind of content that gets viral on different digital platforms in India (like WhatsApp, Instagram, etc.) and list out any interesting patterns you spot
- Understand why content and its virality matters for these platforms and its users
- Identify the areas that you would focus on to make sure that users do not leave the platform

Judgement Criteria & Guidelines:

- **Understanding of the Market & User Psychology:** Depth of research into the drivers of content virality, types of misleading content, and the psychological impact on users
- **Novelty & Relevance:** Innovativeness of the problem framing and the relevance of the identified pain-points to the Indian digital context
- **User-Centricity:** Focus on empowering the end-user (content consumer) rather than solely relying on platform-level enforcement
- **Clarity of Submission:** Well-structured, concise, and relevant content adhering to the one-page format

Deliverables:

Submit a 1-pager document in PDF/PPT/DOC format ONLY (excluding cover slides). The content must be structured to fit within the constraints of a single page, focusing on high-impact insights and clear prioritization.

- **DOC/DOCX:** Single-spaced, 1-inch margins on all sides, Times New Roman - size 12.
- **PPT/PPTX:** Ensure all elements are clearly visible, and content does not exceed more than 1 slide.
- **PDF:** Submission should follow the rules of DOC/PPT, whichever is of higher relevance.

Ensure that your submission is original content. Plagiarized content will not be accepted